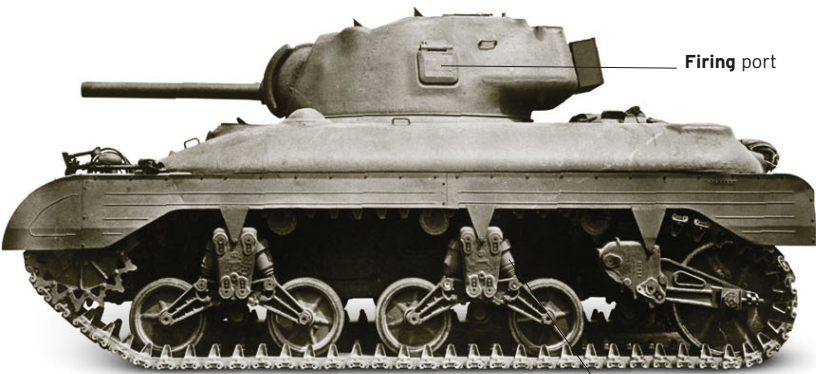


Experimental Vehicles

The pressures of war saw a large number of tank designs being developed, with many never seeing service. Some were rendered obsolete due to advances in technology, or canceled because the war ended before they could be developed. Others were abandoned because existing vehicles, while perhaps not as capable as the replacement, were good enough, and the delays to production that would be caused by introducing a new type of tank were seen as unacceptable.



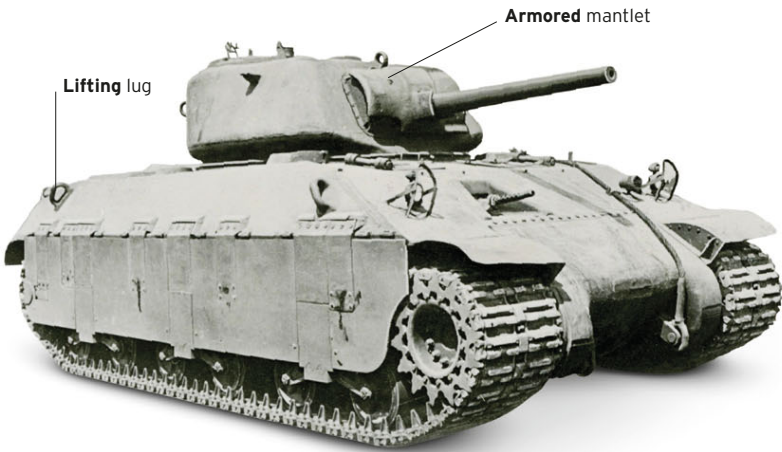
△ M7
Date 1942 Country USA
Weight 26.9 tons (24.4 tonnes)
Engine Wright Continental R-975 gasoline, 400 hp
Main armament 75 mm M3 L/40 gun

Originally designed as a 14 ton (12.7 tonne) light tank, the M7 grew significantly in size during development. It was reclassified as a medium tank, but this placed it in competition with the M4 Sherman (see pp.86-89). The M4 was a superior vehicle and was already in production, so the M7 was abandoned after only seven were built.



△ TOG II*
Date 1941 Country UK
Weight 89.6 tons (81.3 tonnes)
Engine Paxman Ricardo 12-cylinder diesel, 600 hp
Main armament QF 17-pounder gun

Created by the men responsible for the first tank in 1915, "The Old Gang" (TOG) was designed to operate on a World War I-style battlefield. It was large, heavy, and slow. Combat experience in World War II showed that the TOG was no longer suited to modern warfare.



△ T14
Date 1943 Country USA
Weight 42 tons (38.1 tonnes)
Engine Ford GAZ V8 gasoline, 520 hp
Main armament 75 mm M3 L/40 gun

Intended as a heavy Infantry or assault tank for both American and British forces, the T14 used many Sherman components. Two pilot models were built. Testing showed they were too heavy for practical battlefield use, and did not offer sufficient improvement over the Sherman and Churchill to be worth pursuing.

